

The thing that matters most is the thing you never notice.

Two grams of zinc run protein synthesis, hormone production, immune response and recovery. Take it away and everything downstream quietly fails. You have never once thought about it. That sentence is the brand, and this book is how it is built.

FITNESS · DHAKA, BANGLADESH WEAR · FUEL · INSTRUMENTS
INTERNAL — FOR THE TEAM

THE MISSION

We make the small correct things training actually runs on, and we publish the proof.

Why we exist

In this market a claim is free and proof is not. Everything we sell states its number: grams, batch, date, and the lab that measured it.

Who it is for

People training in Dhaka who keep going after anyone stopped watching. Diaspora second, and the order matters.

The promise

Product is the proof, not the pitch. If a line could sit on a competitor's site with the logo swapped, it does not ship.

TWO LINES THAT EXPLAIN THE REST

Everything fills because a body fills: blood moving, a dose landing, a level rising toward ready.

The mark is red because muscle is, and woven in carbon because that is what repetition makes — many small fibres, one strong object.

IF YOU READ ONE PAGE, READ THIS ONE

Ten rules

1. **Quiet is the position.** Every rival sells the shout. We sell the small correct input, repeated after anyone stopped watching.
2. **Night for the brand, Day for the proof.** Obsidian carries the story; Zinc Wash carries sizes, doses, lab panels and policy.
3. **One live colour.** The elixir teal means alive, measured, recovering, correct. Under 8% of any screen.
4. **The red belongs to the object, not to the page.** It is the mark's own carbon fibre. Never a button, a band, a headline or a warning.
5. **Colour is an event.** If two coloured things fight for attention on one screen, one of them is wrong.
6. **Dots mean where you are. Liquid means what you do.** Those are the only two motion grammars.
7. **Gradients live inside liquid only.** Zinc is a solid; a gradient on a surface would be the first dishonest thing on the page.
8. **One type family, pushed to both extremes.** Archivo narrow and heavy for display, normal for reading. Bangla sits beside English, never beneath it.
9. **Nothing loops.** Motion answers a person. It never performs on its own.
10. **Say what the thing is.** If a line could sit on a competitor's site with the logo swapped, rewrite it.

The brand

ZinStim is a fitness brand from Dhaka that sells confidence, and treats the product as the proof rather than the pitch.

Wear

What you put on. Training tees first, cut and weight stated in grams, not adjectives.

Fuel

What you take in. Creatine and protein, with an independent lab panel published beside each batch.

Instruments

What measures it. Watches and bands. Not open yet: an empty door is the first promise a brand cannot keep.

Who it is for

Bangladesh first, the diaspora second, and the order matters. Bangla sits beside English with equal standing, not as a translation toggle. For readers abroad, being built in Dhaka is the asset, not the thing to soften.

Where it is now

Story first, waitlist only, nothing for sale. No transaction means no regulatory dependency, so the brand can be alive months before the product ships. It also matches the argument: the thing worth having is the thing built slowly. The waitlist is the only button on the site.

The name

Zin — from zinc

Element 30. A trace mineral: your body holds about two grams of it, and that is the whole supply. It runs protein synthesis, testosterone, immune response and recovery. It is the smallest correct thing in the system, and nobody thanks it.

Stim — from stimulus

The training stress that causes the body to adapt: stimulus, recovery, adaptation. Deliberately *stimulus*, not *stimulant*. We are not in the caffeine business, and the brand never sells a jolt.

Put together: **the small correct input that causes a change**. The name is the thesis, which is why the brand can be quiet everywhere else.

SETTING	CORRECT	WRONG	WHY
Written	ZinStim	Zinstim · ZINSTIM · Zin-Stim · Zin Stim	Two capitals hold the two halves of the idea together in one word.
Said	zin·stim	zine·stim	Short i, as in zinc. Two beats, stress on the first.
In a sentence	ZinStim is a fitness brand.	The ZinStim.	It is a name, not a category.
In Bangla	জিনস্টিম	Transliterations that add a vowel	Set in Anek Bangla beside the English, never as a subtitle under it.

The idea: Trace

Change is not made of dramatic gestures. It is made of small correct inputs, repeated past the point where anyone is watching.

Why this idea holds

It comes out of the name instead of being applied to it. It makes the sparse layouts mean something: sparse because the subject is *trace*, not sparse because there was nothing to put there. And it gives us the one thing the category does not have — a position that cannot be copied by turning the volume up.

The one moment

Zinc is explained exactly once on the whole site, as a full-bleed divider. After that it is never mentioned again: no atomic numbers, no periodic table, no lab language anywhere else.

**Two grams of it.
You never noticed.**

THE TEST

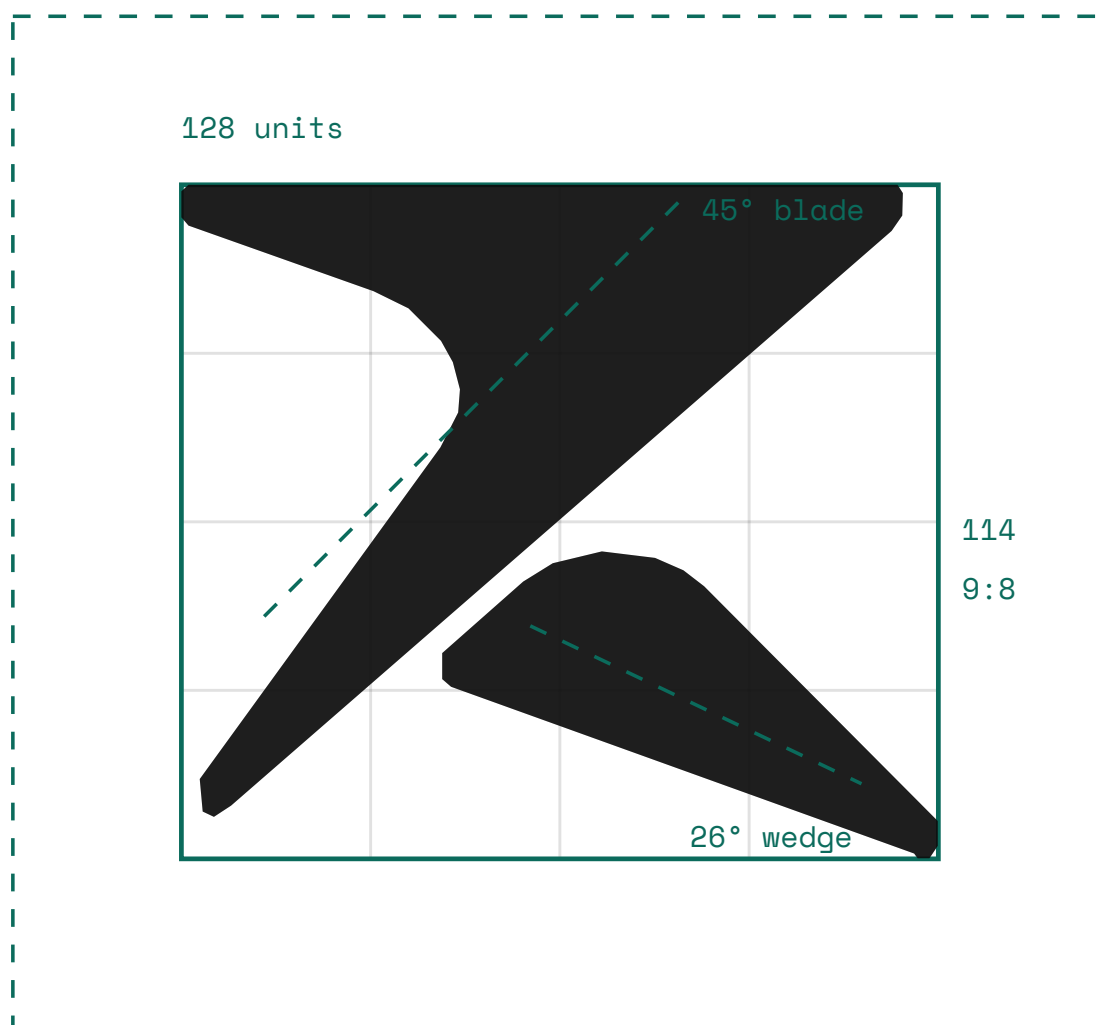
**Every other brand in this aisle
sells the gesture. We sell the
opposite, and it is the more
honest of the two.**

Confidence, correctly defined: shouting is insecurity at volume. Confidence is quiet, specific and unbothered — which is also what the layout looks like.

The mark

A swept blade-form Z, drawn as one closed silhouette in a 128 × 114 box. It is a letter, a tool and a vessel at the same time.

clear space = 0.25 H



Anatomy

The blade is the long stroke, its axis at 45°: the stimulus, the cut, the training stress.

The wedge answers it at 26°, low and to the right: the base the stimulus acts on.

Read together they make a Z with a stroke through it — zinc, and a measurement mark.

The proportion is fixed at **9:8**, wider than it is tall, so the mark sits as an object rather than a letter. Nothing inside it is decoration: the silhouette is one closed path, which is why it survives at 16 pixels and in a single woven thread.

It is a vessel

The shape has an inside, and the inside can hold something. That is what makes the whole motion system possible, and it is why the mark is never filled with a flat colour: what fills it is a material.

THE REVEAL

The red is found, not shown

The mark is red because muscle is, and woven in carbon because that is what repetition makes: many small fibres, one strong object.

At rest it is Zinc Silver on Night, Obsidian on Day. Point at it and a liquid rises inside the silhouette and uncovers the artwork. The brand's whole argument, performed in one interaction: the thing that matters is the thing you only notice when you look.



Sizes and space

USE	SIZE	NOTE
Silhouette, screen	16 px min	One closed path, so it holds.
With the reveal	32 px min	Below this the liquid edge is not readable.
Print	6 mm min	Solid ink, no screens or halftones.
Tab icon	64 px	The artwork itself — the one place red is the whole picture.
Clear space	0.25 × H	On all four sides. Nothing enters it, including type.

DO

- + Zinc Silver on Night, Obsidian on Day.
- + Let the artwork arrive through the reveal, or as the tab icon.
- + Keep the 9:8 proportion exactly.
- + Give it its clear space, even when space is tight.
- + Use the silhouette alone for embroidery, embossing and single-colour print.

Wordmark and lockup

The wordmark is **ZinStim** set in Archivo at width 78, weight 900, with both capitals. In the horizontal lockup the mark stands at the wordmark's full line height and the gap between them is a quarter of the mark's width. The mark may stand alone; the wordmark may stand alone; nothing else joins them inside the clear space.



DON'T

- Never set the mark in Flame Teal, or in any flat red.
- Never outline it, add a shadow, a bevel or a glow.
- Never rotate, stretch, skew or re-space the two parts.
- Never place it on a busy photograph without its own plate.
- Never loop the reveal, or play it without a person asking.
- Never lock it up with another brand's logo inside the clear space.

Colour

The system is called **Deep Zinc**: night, metal, one live colour — and a red that belongs to the object rather than to the page.

The four materials

Night. Obsidian #0D0D0D is the ground the brand speaks from. Not pure black: black is a hole, obsidian is a surface, and it keeps the mark's edge.

Metal. Zinc Wash, Zinc Silver and Graphite are the element itself — cool and bluish, never warm. They carry every word and every surface.

One live colour. The elixir, a teal. It means alive, measured, recovering, correct. It is the only colour allowed to mean something.

The mark's own red. Crimson carbon fibre. It is a finish on an object, the way a taillight lens or an anodised edge is red. It is not a colour we paint with.

The ratio: 90 / 8 / 2



- 90% night and metal
- 8% the live colour
- 2% the mark's red

Measured across a whole screen, not per element. If you can see two red things at once, one of them is wrong. If the teal is the first thing you notice, there is too much of it.

Two surfaces: Night and Day

The brand argues in the dark and proves itself in the light. It is also practical: Bangladesh first means mid-range Android in daylight, where long reading and dense tables on near-black are punishing.

SURFACE	GROUND	TYPE	LIVE COLOUR	WHERE IT IS USED
Night	#0D0D0D	#E9ECEE	#00E0B8 · #12B394	Home, Origin, the drop, campaign, packaging, social
Day	#E9ECEE	#0D0D0D	#0B6B5C	Size charts, lab panels, dose tables, policy, this book

The live colour changes value with the surface, never hue: Flame Teal is a dark-surface colour (1.4:1 on Zinc Wash, invisible), and the Elixir core is its daylight equivalent at 5.4:1.

THE DECISION THIS EDITION SETTLES

Red is the material the
mark is made of. It is
not the brand's colour.

An earlier experiment led with crimson: crimson buttons, a crimson band, a crimson glow. It looked strong in isolation and wrong as a system. Five reasons, in the order they matter.

1 · It contradicts the argument

Red is the colour of alarm and appetite — that is why it works in fast food and clearance sales. A brand whose whole thesis is the quiet, unnoticed, correct input cannot lead with the loudest colour in the spectrum. Shouting is insecurity at volume.

2 · The system already spent red

Failure is red. Our fail token #B0332B sits **0.033** from the mark's crimson in OKLab — roughly a step and a half apart. Make crimson the action colour and “join the list” looks like “this went wrong”. For a brand whose third category is instruments, that is a systems error, not a matter of taste.

3 · It is the category uniform

Black and red is the default of the supplement aisle and the training-apparel shelf. Standing next to it in a louder version of the same colour is not differentiation.

4 · It cannot carry a word

Mark crimson on Obsidian measures **3.35:1** (APCA Lc 23). That fails for text at every size. A colour that cannot hold a sentence on our own ground is a finish, not a system colour.

5 · Red and green is the common blindness

About one man in twelve. Simulated for deuteranopia, our pass and fail colours land **0.076** apart, and crimson against the elixir core lands **0.091** — near enough to the same colour. So no state may be carried by hue alone, and adding red to the action layer doubles a risk we already manage.

How loud is our red, actually

Chroma in OKLCH, on one scale from 0 to 0.25. The mark's crimson carries about a third less chroma than the reds it would be shelved beside: it is an oxide, not a flame.



What a red-green blind reader sees

The same four colours, simulated at full deuteranopia. This is why state is never carried by colour alone: every dot has a label, every pass or fail has a word.



Pass and fail become almost the same colour. Crimson and teal stay apart mainly because they differ in lightness, which is a reason to keep them far apart in value as well as hue.

Where red is allowed

ALLOWED

- + The mark's artwork, uncovered by the reveal.
- + The tab icon and the app icon.
- + Physical finishes: a crimson thread in a woven label, anodised edges, print on black.
- + Photography of the object, where the red is the thing's own surface.
- + The fail token, at interface scale, where something genuinely failed.

Why teal, and why only one

It is in the source material. The mood board is near-black almost everywhere. Exactly one electric colour event sits in it: a teal-green car against night asphalt.

It sits opposite the mark. Crimson reads at hue 356°, the elixir at 171° — five degrees off a true opposite. The one colour we use and the one colour the object is made of never compete; each makes the other look more like itself.

It is what zinc does. Mineral in solution, water, recovery. Metal is zinc on a shelf; the elixir is zinc once it is inside you.

It has a local root. The Bangladesh flag's green #006A4E sits 0.023 away in OKLab and 6.5° of hue from our Elixir. A neighbour, never a flag.

One accent, not two. A second brand colour is how systems lose their meaning. Info blue and the pass / warn / fail trio are interface tools for instruments and forms, not brand colours.

The palette

Every value is measured, not estimated: OKLCH for hue, chroma and lightness; WCAG 2 ratios and APCA Lc for legibility. Two figures are given for each colour — against Night and against Day.

THE METAL · 90%

COLOUR	HEX	OKLCH	ON NIGHT	ON DAY	JOB
 Obsidian	#0D0D0D	16% 0.000 —	—	16.4:1	Night ground. Type on Day.
 Zinc Wash	#E9ECEE	94% 0.004 236°	16.4:1	—	Day ground. Type on Night.
 Zinc Silver	#D6DDE2	89% 0.010 239°	14.2:1	1.2:1	The mark on Night. Rules, dividers, metal surfaces.
 Graphite	#6E7679	56% 0.011 222°	4.2:1	3.9:1	Captions and meta at 14 px and up. Never body copy.
 Muted	#828C90	63% 0.013 224°	5.7:1	2.9:1	Secondary text on Night only.

NOT ALLOWED

- Buttons, links, hovers, focus rings, badges.
- Bands, panels, packaging fields, category colours.
- Headlines, painted words, underlines.
- Charts, data marks, progress.
- Anything meaning “act now” or “hurry”.

What we rejected

DIRECTION	WHY NOT
Crimson as the action colour	The five reasons above. Strong in one screenshot, wrong as a system.
Fire red #E11D2A	Not our red: 55% more chroma, and the exact uniform of the category.
Indigo to electric blue gradient	No link to zinc, fights the red mark, and white type dies on its light end at 2.2:1. Also the most generated look of the moment.
Warm cream #EFEFE4 and terracotta	Warm against a cool metal, and the current default look of an AI-made page.
A second accent	Two accents mean neither means anything.
Pure black #000000	A hole rather than a surface; it swallows the mark's edge and bands on cheap screens.

THE ELIXIR · 8%

COLOUR	HEX	OKLCH	ON NIGHT	ON DAY	JOB
 Elixir void	#062821	25% 0.041 176°	1.2:1	13.3:1	The substance at depth. Gives a liquid body without lighting the page.
 Elixir deep	#0A4A3F	37% 0.064 178°	1.9:1	8.6:1	The body of a pour.
 Elixir	#0B6B5C	47% 0.084 178°	3.0:1	5.4:1	The core. The live colour on Day — the only elixir that may carry small type on light.
 Elixir lit	#12B394	69% 0.128 174°	7.3:1	2.2:1	Where light enters the liquid. Night only.
 Flame Teal	#00E0B8	81% 0.154 174°	11.4:1	1.4:1	Live states on Night: you are here, success, the level line. Never on Day.
 Elixir glow	#5BF5D6	88% 0.137 177°	14.3:1	1.1:1	The specular rim. Rarest — use least.

THE MARK'S OWN RED · 2% · READ OFF THE ARTWORK, NOT CHOSEN

COLOUR	HEX	OKLCH	SHARE OF THE ARTWORK	JOB
 Shadow crimson	#27090C	19% 0.051 17°	11.5%	The weave's shadow.
 Deep crimson	#480F15	27% 0.086 19°	19.1%	The body of the fibre.
 Oxblood	#671E24	35% 0.104 20°	18.5%	Mid weave.
 Mark crimson	#AE4047	53% 0.144 20°	9.1%	The lit face. The single value to match in thread, ink or anodising.

INTERFACE SIGNALS · NOT BRAND COLOURS

COLOUR	ON DAY	ON NIGHT	JOB
 Pass	#2C6E4F · 5.1:1	#52D89B · 10.8:1	A lab panel row that met its claim.
 Warn	#8A5B12 · 4.9:1	#F0B429 · 10.4:1	Pending, unverified, awaiting a result.
 Fail	#B0332B · 5.3:1	#FF7A6B · 7.6:1	A genuine failure. Always with a word beside it.
 Info	#256D91 · 4.8:1	#6BC2EC · 9.8:1	Instruments: scales, ticks, measurement. Never decoration.

Standards and sizes

What each colour is allowed to do, at what size, and the figure that permits it.
Anything not on this list needs a measurement before it ships.

ELEMENT	COLOUR	MINIMUM SIZE	MEASURED
Body copy on Night	#E9ECEE	16 px	16.4:1
Secondary copy on Night	#B7BEC2	14 px	10.3:1
Body copy on Day	#0D0D0D	16 px	16.4:1
Caption and meta on Day	#6E7679	14 px · never body copy	3.9:1 · Lc 61
Liquid headline on Night	#00E0B8	40 px and up	11.4:1
Live text and links on Day	#0B6B5C	14 px	5.4:1
“You are here” dot	#00E0B8	5 px, always with its label	11.4:1
Button at rest on Night	#E9ECEE on a #00E0B8 rim	15 px label · 44 px tap target	16.4:1
Button once filled	#0D0D0D on #00E0B8	15 px	11.4:1
Rules and dividers	rgba(233,236,238,.12)	1 px	Decorative: never the only cue
The mark	#D6DDE2 on Night	16 px · 32 px for the reveal · 6 mm print	14.2:1
The mark's red	artwork only	64 px tab icon	3.35:1 – never type
Dose line on the pack	#00E0B8	1.5 mm	Physical — match to a swatch

How much. The live colour stays under 8% of a screen: in practice no more than three teal things visible at once, and one button per page — the waitlist. The mark's red is the only red in the frame.

Pairings

PAIR	MEASURED	
Zinc Wash on Obsidian	16.4:1 · Lc 95	any size
Obsidian on Zinc Wash	16.4:1 · Lc 94	any size
Flame Teal on	11.4:1 · Lc 73	any size

Off the screen

Fabric. Garment dye mutes colour: match crimson thread and teal stitching to a physical swatch before signing, never to the hex. Buy the swatch first.

Print. Obsidian prints as a rich black, not 100% K alone. The

Flame Teal on Obsidian	11.4:1 · Lc 70	any size
Flame Teal on Elixir void	9.3:1 · Lc 65	inside a liquid
Elixir on Zinc Wash	5.4:1 · Lc 70	text on Day
Zinc Wash on Mark crimson	4.9:1 · Lc 71	object labels only
Elixir lit on Zinc Wash	2.2:1	never
Flame Teal on Zinc Wash	1.4:1	never
Mark crimson on Obsidian	3.4:1 · Lc 23	never for type

Print. Obsidian prints as a non black, not 100% K alone. The elixir is a spot colour when the budget allows — teal is the first thing four-colour process gets wrong.

Cheap screens. Deep crimson and Elixir void both crush toward black on low-end panels in daylight. Never put information in the difference between two dark values; the level line carries it instead.

Never colour alone. Every state that colour marks also carries a word or a shape — a dot with a label, a pass with the word pass.

Type

One family, pushed to both extremes. Width carries the hierarchy, so a second typeface is never needed.

Why one family

Two earlier passes were wrong and the corrections are worth keeping. A wide grotesque was tried first — but two grams of zinc is concentrated, not spread out, so display had to compress rather than expand. A high-contrast serif was tried next, which is elegant, and elegance is not the same thing as energy.

Archivo is variable in both weight and width. Narrow and heavy, it hits at display size; at normal width it reads quietly for paragraphs. Most brands pair a display face with a body face and get two typefaces having a polite disagreement.

The settings

ROLE	FACE	WIDTH	WEIGHT
Display	Archivo	78	900
Head	Archivo	82	800
Body	Archivo	95	400
Data, labels, specs	Space Mono	—	400 / 700
Bangla	Anek Bangla	84	700

Display · Archivo 78 / 900

Built, not worn.

Head · Archivo 82 / 800

Two grams of it. You never noticed.

Body · Archivo 95 / 400

Small correct things, long after anyone stopped watching. Every claim on this site is a number somebody can check: grams, batch, date, and the lab that measured it.

Data · Space Mono 400

240 GSM · LONG-STAPLE · GARMENT-DYED · BATCH ZS-01 · 2026-09

Bangla · Anek Bangla 84 / 700 · equal standing, never a subtitle

ছোট সঠিক কাজ, বারবার।

DO

- + Keep the measure under 70 characters. Long lines make white space read as neglect.
- + Let width carry hierarchy: compress to shout, relax to explain.
- + Set Bangla beside English at the same level, using the same width logic.
- + Use Space Mono wherever a number must be checkable.

DON'T

- No third typeface, ever.
- No all-caps in Archivo. Uppercase survives only in Space Mono at small sizes, where it reads as instrument lettering.
- No painting one word of a headline a different colour. If the line needs help, rewrite the line — colour may only arrive as the substance filling the type.
- No italics for emphasis in display. Rewrite instead.

Motion, and why everything fills

Everything fills because a body fills: blood moving, a dose landing, a level rising toward ready.

Why it works

It is literally true of the subject. Zinc arrives dissolved and travels in fluid. A dose is a level. Every category we sell is a vessel: a tee takes on sweat, a tub dissolves into a glass, an instrument reads a level. Nothing has to be invented to make the interface mean something.

And it solves the brand problem: restraint is hard to make exciting. A filling liquid gives energy from substance rather than noise — the page moves because something is being readied, not because something is being advertised.

Reveal over display

Nothing is fully visible at rest. The mark holds its material until you point at it, a headline sits half-poured, a product fills as you consider it. Attention is the thing the brand rewards.

Two grammars, and only two

GRAMMAR	MEANS	WHERE
Dots	Where you are	Navigation, current page, live state, a signal beside a word
Liquid	What you do	Buttons, the mark, products, the pour, reading progress

If a new component needs motion, it must be one of these two. A third grammar is a sign the component is wrong, not that the system is short.

LEVELS, AS THEY SHIP



The mark fills past its own top edge — 1.12 — so the wave crest clears the silhouette and no trough is left showing. The headline rests at 0.56 because a half-poured line says the thing is not finished, which is true.

Timing

MOMENT	DURATION	CURVE
Colour answering a pointer	180 ms	ease
A panel or sheet opening	400 ms	ease-out
The mark filling	750 ms	ease-out
A product filling	1000 ms	ease-out
A pour	1600 ms	ease-out

Ease-out for things arriving: `cubic-bezier(.16, 1, .3, 1)`. Ease-in-out only for something travelling between two known positions. Fast enough to feel like a response, slow enough to read as deliberate.

Rules

Nothing loops.	No drifting, pulsing or floating. A loop is decoration, and decoration undermines restraint.
One arrival moment.	A single settling gesture on load. Fading every section up on scroll is the generated-page default.
Motion answers a person.	Hover, focus, press. On a touch screen the middle line of the screen stands in for the cursor, and scrolling may drive a pour — progress, never playback.
Gradients live inside liquid.	A liquid is a volume with light travelling through it. A surface is a surface: zinc is a solid, and a gradient on a button or a card would be the first dishonest thing on the page.
Reduced motion removes movement, never information.	With <code>prefers-reduced-motion</code> , or with no JavaScript, every section shows its finished state.

Voice

Material and quietly technical. Closer to a good watchmaker than to a supplement company.

DO	DON ' T
Short declaratives. Full stop.	Exclamation marks
Specific numbers	"Premium", "elite", "game-changing"
Say what the thing is	Say how it will make them feel
Sentence case	ALL CAPS for emphasis
Let silence do the work	Fill every gap with a benefit

The test: if a line could sit on a competitor's site with the logo swapped, rewrite it.

Lines that are ours

Confidence is built, not worn.

Small correct things, long after anyone stopped watching.

Two grams of it. You never noticed.

240 GSM · LONG-STAPLE · GARMENT-DYED

Words we do not use

Unleash. Beast mode. Grind. Warrior. Domination.
Revolutionary. Game-changing. Any sentence that shouts at the reader is a sentence written by a brand that is not sure of itself.

Pictures, and the moodboard

The look was read off six references. Here is what they actually measure, and the two setups that come out of them.

The moodboard, measured

REFERENCE	WHAT IT IS	BELOW L 30%	ABOVE L 75%	MEAN CHROMA	THE COLOUR EVENT
ref1	A night gym, hard spotlights, black kit on grey concrete	58%	2%	0.010	None. A phone screen at 0.2% of frame.
ref2	The same room, full length, white tee against black	56%	8%	0.013	None.
ref3	ASRV's shop — in the board as a warning, not a target	73%	3%	0.014	Sale red #D12722, chroma 0.205 , over 5.3% of the frame.
ref4	A teal car on night asphalt, taillights lit	73%	3%	0.009	Teal #21967A at 0.6% ; taillight red #780213 at 1.8% .
ref5	The layout sketch — structure, not colour	84%	0%	0.001	None.
ref6	The product render, daylight studio	7%	66%	0.018	The mark, reading as oxblood in that light.

Two things fall out of this table. First, the live colour was not invented: the car's teal measures hue **172°** — two degrees from Elixir Lit and six from Elixir. Second, the ratio was not invented either. In that same frame red covers 1.8% of the pixels and teal 0.6%; **90 / 8 / 2 is what the reference already does**, and section 05 only wrote it down.

Five of the six references are night. One is noon — and it is the one that shows the product.

The product render, read



The object is right. The room is not. A matte black body, a zinc-metal lid engraved with the element, and the mark as the only colour on the pack — that is the whole system in physical form, and it is the best argument yet that red belongs to the object. What surrounds it is a warm, bright set, which is the opposite of every other reference in the board.

MEASURED IN THE RENDER	VALUE	THE BRAND'S VALUE	DISTANCE	READING
Counter	 #E3DDD2 L 90% H 83°	Zinc Wash #E9ECEE H 236°	0.047	Warm cream — and 0.042 from Bone, the cream this brand dropped for being warm.
Back wall	 #D8D2C6 H 85°	—	—	Warm again. The whole set sits at hue 70–97°.
Lid	 #8C8479 H 76°	Zinc Silver #D6DDE2	0.278	A warm grey, nearer Graphite than Zinc Silver. Zinc is a cool metal; this reads brass.
Jar body	 #43443E L 38%	Obsidian #0D0D0D L 16%	0.225	The black lifts by 22 points of lightness under that key. Obsidian stops being obsidian.
Mark, lit face	 #713235	Mark crimson #AE4047	0.134	Right hue (19° against 20°), two steps too dark: it reads oxblood, not crimson.

Two setups, with targets

Targets are for the surfaces as the camera sees them, not for paint. One rule holds both: **every surface stays in the cool band (hue 200–260°) or under 0.010 chroma. Never 60–100° above 0.012** — that single line is the whole difference between the render's room and this brand.

Night — the hero setup

Ground		#0F1214	OKLCH 18% 0.006 236°
Slab or bench		#2B2E30	OKLCH 30% 0.006 236°

One hard key, high and behind to one side, no fill — a black flag where the fill would go. At least half the frame below L 30%, as in ref1 to ref4. The mark is the only colour in shot, about 2% of the pixels. Plates and rack fall into shadow rather than being lit. For home, Origin, the drop, campaign and social.

Day — the specification setup

Ground		#D8DFE4	OKLCH 90% 0.010 236°
Wall		#BFC5C9	OKLCH 82% 0.008 236°
Slab, mid concrete		#82878A	OKLCH 62% 0.008 236°

Soft north light, cool grey concrete instead of cream limestone, flat and even. The jar stays matte black at L 16–22%: expose for the pack, not for the room. For size charts, dose tables, lab panels and anything a person checks rather than admires.

The render is one grade away from the second setup. Same framing, same props minus the tile floor: swap cream stone for cool concrete and pull the white balance cool, and it belongs.

The pack itself

PART	SPECIFICATION
Body	Matte Obsidian, no gloss varnish. Gloss is what lifts the black to L 38% under a key light.
Lid	Cool metal — zinc, or aluminium anodised grey. Not brass-toned. Knurled edge is correct: it is a tool's grip.
Lid engraving	Zn 30, struck once. This is the pack's one naming moment — which is why the floor of Zn tiles goes. The lid already says it, and a trace repeated a dozen times is not a trace.
The mark	Flat, one colour, in its clear space. On the pack it may be a raised or enamel badge — that is a finish. In any digital file it stays flat: no bevel, no gloss highlight, no drop shadow, no silver keyline.
Wordmark	ZinStim , two capitals, Archivo 78 / 900. The render's rounded italic “zinStim” is not the wordmark.
The live colour	One teal line at the fill level, marking the dose. The only colour on the pack besides the mark.
Back of pack	Batch, date, lab and grams in Space Mono, tabular. Bangla beside English.

DO

- + Near-black sets, one hard light source, deep falloff — at least half the frame below L 30%.
- + Cool light: steel, water, chalk dust, wet concrete, night asphalt.
- + Keep every surface in the cool band, or under 0.010 chroma.
- + Light the product like a tool on a bench, not a trophy on a plinth.
- + Real gyms and real light in Dhaka. The origin is the asset.
- + Let the red appear only where it actually is: the object's own finish.
- + Leave room for the mark and its clear space when shooting.

DON'T

- No orange gym lighting, no warm grade, no teal-and-orange. Cream stone is the warm the brand already rejected.
- No prop that repeats what the pack already says once — one Zn, not a floor of them.
- No generated image with garbled micro-text on a label, a tile or a spec panel. Redraw the type or reshoot.
- No grimacing, veins, or mid-rep screaming.
- No motivational type burned into a photograph.
- No stock-looking studio white sweeps for brand images — those belong on Day surfaces, in a spec panel.
- No red gels, filters or coloured smoke.

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In use

SURFACE	GROUND	THE MARK	LIVE COLOUR	NOTES
Site, brand pages	Obsidian	Zinc Silver, reveal on pointer	Flame Teal	One button on the page, and it is the waitlist.
Site, spec pages	Zinc Wash	Obsidian	Elixir	Size charts, lab panels, policy, dose tables.
Fuel tub	Obsidian	Zinc Silver	One teal level line marking the dose	Batch, date and lab printed in Space Mono. Crimson only in the printed artwork.
Wear label	Black woven	Silver thread	—	One crimson thread is allowed: it is the mark's own colour, not a decoration.
Instrument face	Obsidian	Zinc Silver at 16 px	Teal readout, Info blue ticks	Numbers in Space Mono, tabular.
Social	Obsidian tiles	Silver, 64 px minimum	Teal, one element per tile	No red fields. No text over a busy crop without a plate.
Tab and app icon	—	The red artwork itself	—	The only place the red is the whole picture.
Email and invoices	Zinc Wash	Obsidian	Elixir	Day surface: it is a document, not a campaign.

Keeping it

Fixed

Changing any of these is a brand decision, not a design one: the name and its spelling; the mark's geometry, proportion and clear space; the two surfaces; one live colour; red as material rather than paint; the type family; dots and liquid as the only two grammars; nothing loops.

Still open

Photography — nothing shot yet. Instruments, until there is a real product behind the door. Bangla at display sizes. A spot-colour match for the elixir in print, and a crimson thread swatch for Wear. Whether the homepage goes Night immediately or at the first drop.

Settled in this edition

Red is the mark's material, not the brand's colour. The crimson-led direction is rejected, for the five measured reasons in section 05.

The elixir rule is refined. “Never on light” was written for Elixir Lit and above (2.2:1 and worse). The Elixir core measures 5.4:1 on Zinc Wash and may carry small type there.

Uppercase is allowed in Space Mono only, at small sizes, where it reads as instrument lettering.

No glow behind type. The lab's crimson bloom is not adopted: surfaces stay flat, and light stays inside liquid.

How to change something

Every value in this book has a reason. If a reason stops being true, change the value — and write down which reason died. Proposals live in the decision log with the measurement that makes the case; nothing is built from a proposal.

The colour lab is where directions get tried before they get proposed: five directions on the same brand pieces, a mixer for building new ones, and contrast measured live. It is a workbench, not a spec — this book is the spec.

ZinStim brand book · edition 01 · September 2026
Contrast measured with WCAG 2 and APCA 0.0.98G-4g

Set in Archivo, Space Mono and Anek Bangla
Internal document – not for publication